

texts, WhatsApp, and social media. After this explanation, you may think why buy premium or flagship phones at all if mid-range phones are so capable? And for most users, our answer would be – go for capable mid-range devices. We'd advise users to go for flagship or premium devices only when they have very specific needs. Firstly, if you're an iOS user and are deeply integrated into the OS, buying an iPhone is a no brainer.

If you do buy the iPhone 11 or XR, you do lose out on some pretty integral feature such as a secondary telephoto rear lens and an OLED display, but the battery is bigger than the XS surprisingly. The iPhone 11 also loses out on the OLED display, HDR10, ultrawide camera and some more features. An LCD display may feel like a massive letdown at the price point of ₹64,900 since Android phones costing less than half of that feature it. However, if you have no qualms with these losses go for the budget iPhones.

Similarly, if you're a huge fan of Samsung's One UI, the mid-range smartphones are pretty lack-lustre in comparison to the flagships since they not only sacrifice hardware such as the SoC, RAM and more, but also remove some integral software.

Overall, if you're going for a brand like Samsung, it's best to stick with their flagship devices since their expertise lies in such high-end phones, with the mid-range ones being treated more as options to target the masses. However, Samsung A series does have excellent devices such as the A50, so there are always exceptions. If you're going for brands like Xiaomi, Lenovo, Motorola or OnePlus, you can almost always be assured that their mid-range devices will be efficient, since they specialise in those which is why they have so many devices termed 'flagship killers'.

When buying a smartphone, you also need to research the latest features in the smartphone market and figure out which ones you're most likely to use. Are you an avid smartphone photographer? Go for the Pixel 3 (or even the new 4) or the Huawei P or Mate series. Do you want the best, most fluid performance? Turn to the OnePlus phones. Are you looking for a relatively cheap phone that 'kills flagships'? Go for Poco or the Xiao-

mi Redmi K series. Do you want a solid all-rounder? Go for a Samsung flagship or an iPhone model. You also need to figure out if you should go with iOS or Android devices. If you like customising your phone and tinkering around with it in general, you're #TeamAndroid. If you desire an easy-to-use interface and timely updates, you're #TeamiOS. Or even #TeamPixel. The only thing you'd miss on the Pixel is the barrage of better-optimised apps.

Don't go for gimmicky phones that have flashy words such as "octa-core", "water-proof" or some of the more ridiculous ones such as 'vein recognition'. Chipset manufacturers know the word 'octa-core' will sell more and will try to incorporate this into devices even when the software and hardware don't really match up to it. More cores don't always translate to better performance. Look up videos online for Benchmarking tests of the phone you're planning to buy. You can check the multi-core performance in tests such as AnTuTu and Geekbench to assess how they stack up in comparison to other phones and their real-world performance.

If you're an avid gamer, go for smartphones that have capable processors such as the latest Qualcomm Snapdragon, HiSilicon Kirin, Exynos or iOS chipset, a good amount of RAM, a multi-core processor and some sort of cooling technology. The ASUS ROG Phone II, Razer Phone 2, and Xiaomi Black Shark are specifically targeted towards gamers and most gaming smartphones are reasonably priced.

One more thing to keep in mind is to pay attention to release cycles.



ASUS ROG Phone II is a no brainer for avid mobile gamers

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Budli has tied up with CRY and GivelIndia to provide for the welfare of underprivileged children. If you're buying a new smartphone this season, you can donate your old one to Budli and they will give part of the funds acquired from your product to Sikshana Foundation or CRY.

Most companies follow a release cycle pattern by releasing their new devices once or maybe twice (or thrice) a year. Follow these cycles carefully to avoid making heart-wrenching mistakes like buying the Pixel 3XL just a few days before the Pixel 4 and 4XL release. Not only could you have bought the newer model, but you could have also stuck with your guns and bought the old one at a heavily-discounted rate.

Recommerce or buying secondhand, refurbished smartphones is another ingenious way to get more bang for your buck since you often see people selling a brand new smartphone which you can snag for a discounted rate. Budli.in, Cashify, YNew and webuy.com are some of the best places to go and find your desired smartphone. It's considerably cheaper and some places even offer a 2-year warranty period instead of the standard one year.

To conclude, to buy a new smartphone, first select your budget-range, figure out your personal needs, choose a smartphone after reading up extensively about it and then buy it. Or maybe, cut your budget in half and look for a capable smartphone that does exactly the same or more. If your expectation from a smartphone is performance, you could dump the OnePlus 7 Pro you were going to purchase and maybe go for the Redmi K20 Pro! You've effectively cut your expenditure by almost half and you get the same processor, the same 6/8GB RAM, both run on the same version of Android, a triple-lens setup and more. Be smart this Diwali and save your hard-earned money. You could use this money to maybe take up an Adobe Creative Cloud course or any other course that will expand your skill set. 